

Axel Waserman

Senior Engineering Manager | Backend & Data

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Professional Summary

Hands-on Senior Engineering Manager working at the intersection of product engineering, high-availability data architecture, and distributed team operations. Expert in building resilient, async-first engineering cultures where I stay off the critical path to eliminate cross-border friction and optimize delivery velocity. Proven track record of scaling critical backend systems, integrating platforms post-acquisition (Hotjar), and cultivating high-trust, high-retention teams across multiple time zones.

Core Competencies & Technologies

Engineering Leadership: Remote & Async Team Management, Empathetic Leadership & Mentorship, High-Bar Technical Hiring, Cross-Border Team Integration, Agile Delivery, Product-Engineering Alignment.

Backend & Systems Architecture: Distributed Systems, Microservices, Internal Developer Platforms, High-Availability Data Pipelines, Cloud Architecture, Self-Serve Data Systems.

Hands-on Tech Stack: Python, FastAPI, PydanticAI (AI Agents/Data Validation), SQL, Cloud Data Warehouses (Snowflake, BigQuery, Redshift), ELT (dbt, Airflow), CI/CD Tooling, Git, REST & GraphQL APIs.

Professional Experience

Contentsquare (Global Digital Experience Analytics SaaS)

Senior Engineering Manager

May 2025 – Present

Engineering Manager

Jan 2024 – Apr 2025

- Promoted to lead a newly formed, geographically distributed department of 5 Engineers following the acquisition of Hotjar. Tasked with merging distinct engineering cultures, modernizing the data backend, and delivering high-leverage data products.
- **Post-Acquisition Integration:** Successfully integrated Hotjar's remote-first team culture into Contentsquare, standardizing async documentation frameworks and workflows across 4 time zones to eliminate cultural friction and synchronous dependencies.
- **Scaled Business-Critical Backend & Data Platform:** Architected and scaled a highly reliable system orchestrating 10,000 data assets across a 20TB data estate. Powering global company reporting, sales commission payouts, Product Qualified Leads (PQL) computation, and automated retention orchestrators with a zero data downtime record.
- **Built Self-Serve Systems:** Directed the hands-on development of a secure, internal API and data access system, enabling non-technical stakeholders to safely query the main data warehouse. Eliminated engineering bottlenecks and fostered an autonomous engineering environment.
- **Drove Engineering Velocity:** Revamped the team's CI/CD practices, automated testing frameworks, and deployment workflows, increasing deployment frequency by 40% and Q-o-Q initiative delivery by 20%.
- **Cultivated High-Performing, Resilient Teams:** Led full-cycle engineering hiring with a 100% probation pass rate. Maintained 100% team retention across a fully distributed team by anchoring operations in documentation, running blameless post-mortems, and fostering psychological safety.

Data Engineer II

Jan 2023 – Dec 2023

Data Engineer I

May 2022 – Dec 2022

- Operated as a core IC building a reliable data backend to unify internal systems across the organization.
- Designed and implemented scalable backend ELT pipelines using Python, FastAPI, and modern orchestration tooling, enabling product-led growth.
- Transitioned the engineering function to a "product-oriented" operating model, building internal tools that minimized operational dependencies for data scientists and analysts.

- Optimized legacy infrastructure (Redshift, scripted Python ETLs, cron) while actively migrating them to modern, cost-efficient cloud architectures.
- Established robust backend engineering standards by writing comprehensive unit/integration tests and implementing CI/CD pipelines from scratch.

PwC France

- Data Engineer**

 - Consultant within the Data Assurance team, architecting technical solutions for enterprise clients.
 - Built an end-to-end data platform from scratch (ingestion, backend transformations, cloud logic) for a global cement association.
 - Acted as Co-Product Owner and full-stack engineer for internal ESG and risk assessment web applications for major banking and enterprise clients.
- Feb 2021 – Apr 2022**

Panodysey

- Software Engineer**

 - Designed and implemented the core content ranking backend algorithm and built automated web-scraping pipelines, resulting in a 30% increase in user acquisition.
- Mar 2020 – Aug 2020**

Education

- ESILV (Ecole Supérieure d'Ingénieurs Léonard de Vinci)**

Master of Engineering – Mathematics and Computer Science
- 2017 – 2021**

- Griffith College Dublin**

Computer Science (Study Abroad Semester)
- 2020 – 2021**